



INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION FOR DIGITAL CHILD

Human Resource Policy (HRP)

2023



IFDC 

1. Preamble

The International Foundation for Digital Child (IFDC) is dedicated to creating a world where every child thrives in a healthy, safe environment and becomes a successful citizen in the digital age. Our mission is to mentor children in leading balanced and healthy digital lives while supporting parents in providing unwavering care. We are committed to educating both children and parents on responsible digital usage, fostering creative expression, and amplifying children's voices.

IFDC acknowledges that its greatest asset in achieving its vision and mission is its dedicated team of professionals. Our Human Resources (HR) policy is rooted in our core values and objectives, ensuring that our team is empowered, respected, and aligned with the organization's mission.

This HR policy serves as a guiding framework for recruitment, employment, and professional development within IFDC. It upholds principles of fairness, diversity, and equality, recognizing that our work in promoting digital citizenship begins within our own organization.

In line with our strategic objectives, we aim to foster a workplace environment that encourages collaboration, innovation, and continuous growth for our employees. We are dedicated to maintaining a culture of integrity, respect, and inclusivity, ensuring that every team member has the opportunity to thrive and contribute to our mission.

As we embark on our journey to empower children and champion their digital rights, we reaffirm our commitment to valuing and supporting our most valuable resource: our people. This HR policy reflects our dedication to creating a workplace that mirrors the values and aspirations we hold for the children we serve, thus enabling us to fulfill our vision of a world where every child embraces digital citizenship with confidence and responsibility.

2. Acknowledgment Form

I, _____, hereby acknowledge that I have received and thoroughly reviewed the Human Resource Policy Manual of the International Foundation for Digital Citizenship (IFDC). I am committed to fully adhere to all the provisions outlined within the Policy and Guidelines contained therein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Date: _____

By signing this Acknowledgment Form, I affirm my understanding and commitment to uphold the principles and regulations set forth in IFDC's Human Resource Policy Manual. I recognize the importance of compliance in fostering a harmonious and productive work environment that aligns with IFDC's mission of promoting responsible digital citizenship.

3. Definitions

a) Fraud: Fraud within the context of IFDC encompasses a spectrum of activities, including but not limited to deception, bribery, forgery, extortion, theft, conspiracy, embezzlement, misappropriation, false representation, concealment of material facts, and collusion. It refers to

any deliberate attempt to deceive or manipulate IFDC for personal or collective gain, evasion of obligations, or causing detriment to the organization.

b) Corruption: Corruption involves the misuse of entrusted authority or power for personal gain, resulting in the dishonest acquisition of advantages from external parties. It pertains to the improper exploitation of one's position within IFDC to secure private benefits through unethical means.

c) Scope of Benefit: It's important to note that both fraud and corruption extend beyond tangible gains, encompassing intangible benefits such as elevated status or access to privileged information.

d) Fraudulent Activities: Fraud covers a wide array of activities, including, but not limited to:

- **Theft of Assets:** Illegitimate acquisition of IFDC's property or resources.
- **Misappropriation of Funds:** Unauthorized diversion of funds for personal purposes.
- **Misuse of Assets:** Unauthorized personal use of IFDC's assets, like privately using IFDC's vehicles without permission.
- **Deception:** Providing false information, such as misrepresenting qualifications to secure employment.
- **Theft from Partners, Customers, or Suppliers:** Unauthorized taking of assets from IFDC's partners, customers, or suppliers.
- **Theft or Misuse of Data:** Unauthorized access or use of proprietary data, intellectual property, or confidential information.
- **Bribery of Government Officials:** Offering favors to government officials to further personal interests or IFDC's goals.
- **Self-Benefiting Contracts:** Awarding contracts to third parties to advance personal interests rather than IFDC's objectives.

By defining these terms within the context of IFDC, we aim to establish a clear understanding of the boundaries and ethical standards expected of all individuals associated with the organization. These definitions serve as a foundation for preventing and addressing fraudulent and corrupt practices, ensuring IFDC's commitment to transparent and ethical operations in its pursuit of promoting responsible digital citizenship.

4. Statement of Philosophy

At the International Foundation for Digital Citizenship (IFDC), we are committed to cultivating a work environment that nurtures personal and professional growth for all employees. It is the collective responsibility of each staff member to foster an atmosphere of respect, equality, and cooperation. We acknowledge that roles within the organization do not determine a person's worth; instead, we value qualities such as dedication, efficiency, genuine commitment, and a shared passion. Every member of IFDC is accountable for promoting mutual respect and fostering an environment where each individual is treated fairly and with dignity.

All staff members are expected to:

- Encourage cooperation and open communication among colleagues.
- Treat one another with fairness, dignity, and respect.
- Foster teamwork and harmony in all interactions.

- Strive for a shared understanding of performance expectations and communicate regularly to reinforce clarity.
- Welcome and consider the input and opinions of fellow employees, encouraging their participation in decisions that impact their work and careers.
- Support the growth and development of colleagues by assisting them in achieving personal and professional goals both within IFDC and beyond.
- Endeavor to prevent workplace conflicts, and in cases where they arise, address them fairly and swiftly to facilitate resolution.
- Apply organizational policies consistently and equitably, recognizing the importance of each role and individual contribution.
- Demonstrate empathy and understanding toward colleagues who may be experiencing personal challenges.

5. Vision and Mission Statements

VISION: A nation where every child is born and raised in a healthy, safe environment, and educated to be successful citizens in the digital world.

MISSION: Mentor children to lead a balanced and healthy digital life. Coach parents to provide constant care and support for children who need it. The IFDC is dedicated to educating both parents and children on how to use social media, smartphones and other devices, gaming platforms, broadband and media networks, different search engines, etc. in a responsible manner. Train the kids how to express themselves freely, establish positive attitudes, shape their identities, and speak out on topics that impact them by using creative media tools. Produce child-friendly media narratives fostering children's rights. The IFDC will engage with journalists and creative media producers to produce ethically rich media content, including documentaries, films, etc., investigating and amplifying the voice of children and advocating for their rights.

APPROACHES:

1. **Children as Right-Holders:** We strongly believe that our children are equal citizens entitled to human rights entirely. Therefore, they are rights holders, not just beneficiaries. This strategic approach will allow us to outline the responsibilities of key stakeholders, including governments and other institutions, to act proactively at the legislative, political, structural, cultural, economic, and social levels.
2. **Gender Equality and Women's Rights:** Child rights cannot be achieved without addressing women's rights. We see gender equality and women's rights as key pillars in achieving the rights of children. Without achieving gender equality, creating a healthy environment for children to discover their maximum potential is not possible. We also believe that a balanced distribution of power between girls and boys, as well as between women and men, creates a conducive environment for kids to develop their personalities. Our programs primarily recognize the importance of young girls and women being given equal access to all spheres of social life.
3. **Digital Well-being as a Right:** We strongly believe that children have the right to access the internet. It is the responsibility of the state and parents to ensure that children do not face any dangerous and negative experiences when accessing the internet. We are

dedicated to working with the public and private sectors, parents, and communities to ensure that children can safely use the internet and that any unfortunate incidents are handled right away.

4. **Preserving Creativity and Physical Engagement:** IFDC firmly believes that technology cannot rob the creativity and peace of mind of children. Technology cannot take children away from the healthy fun they have in the physical world. Therefore, it is vital for kids to learn their rights and responsibilities not only in the digital sphere but also in the physical world.

5. Employment

a. Employment Equity IFDC is committed to equal employment opportunities and does not discriminate based on factors such as race, ancestry, color, ethnicity, language, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, marital status, physical or mental disability, or financial status. We prioritize the inclusion and advancement of historically disadvantaged groups.

b. Recruitment and Selection All job openings at IFDC are advertised for a minimum of 10 working days. Positions are posted on IFDC's official website, affiliated organizations' websites, and occasionally on employment websites or through agencies. Both current employees and external candidates are encouraged to apply.

Applicants submit their applications along with resumes, demonstrating alignment with the position's minimum criteria. After screening, selected candidates are interviewed, and references may be contacted. Successful candidates receive offers based on qualifications and project requirements.

c. Orientation New IFDC employees undergo an orientation session to introduce general policies, procedures, and operations. This provides an opportunity for newcomers to learn about performance expectations and the organization's values. All employees receive a copy of the Employee Handbook and are expected to study its contents. Policies, including the Code of Ethics, are highlighted, and employees are asked to confirm their adherence.

d. Employee Duties Each employee's job description outlines roles, responsibilities, and additional tasks. This document serves as a basis for evaluating performance, both during and after the probation period. Amendments to job descriptions may occur, involving discussions with the employee and approval from management.

e. Personal Files IFDC maintains secure personal files containing relevant employee information. Only the employee, Director/CEO, and HR personnel have access. Records are kept by the HR department. A log tracks file reviews, and a checklist ensures comprehensive documentation.

f. Probation The first three months of employment constitute the probationary period, during which both parties assess the employment relationship. Probationary employees may be terminated by IFDC with or without cause and without notice. After probation, a meeting reviews progress and determines next steps.

g. Annual Salary Salaries are determined by the Director/CEO based on qualifications and experience, taking budget considerations and selection panel recommendations into account. Employees are paid monthly, with statutory deductions. Salary practices are subject to change at the employer's discretion.

h. Performance Appraisals Performance reviews occur annually. Employees prepare by outlining work plans for the upcoming year. The review assesses past achievements, identifies challenges, and establishes objectives for the future. The appraisal committee conducts the process.

i. Professionalism Employees representing IFDC must adhere to a professional dress code and conduct themselves appropriately. Respectful behavior is expected, and offensive language is discouraged.

j. Discipline IFDC enforces progressive discipline for unsatisfactory performance or unacceptable behavior. Steps may include verbal reprimand, written reprimand, or dismissal, depending on the situation.

k. Hours of Work Regular office hours are 9:00 am - 5:30 pm, Monday through Friday (excluding holidays). Core hours require availability, and all employees work 8 hours per day. Staff should notify supervisors of planned absences and report unplanned absences promptly.

l. Leave IFDC offers various types of leave:

- **Annual/Vacation Leave:** Eligible after 1st year, with prorated entitlement for the first year.
- **Illness:** Casual leave available after the first year; medical certification may be required for absences over two consecutive days.
- **Holidays:** Statutory holidays observed.
- **Maternity Leave:** Eligible for 84 work days with options for pre/post confinement leave.
- **Special Leave:** Granted for compelling or compassionate reasons with a maximum of five workdays per year.

7. Departure

Termination may occur for cause, resignation, or layoff, each with specific procedures and considerations. Employee property must be returned upon departure.

8. Professional Development

IFDC supports employee growth by sponsoring relevant courses, conferences, and seminars. Opportunities aligned with an employee's position or recommended by the Director/CEO may have associated costs covered by IFDC.

9. Health and Safety

IFDC prioritizes a safe workplace and complies with health and safety regulations. Alcohol consumption and illegal drug use are prohibited on the premises. The organization aims to create a smoke-free and scent-sensitive environment.

10. Harassment

IFDC promotes a harassment-free environment and will not tolerate behavior that diminishes the dignity of individuals or creates a hostile atmosphere. Harassment, whether based on race, gender, or any other characteristic, is explicitly prohibited.

11. Workplace Violence

Workplace violence and abuse are strictly prohibited at IFDC. Anyone engaging in such behavior will face disciplinary action, including termination and potential legal consequences.

12. Dispute Resolution

Conflict resolution processes involve open communication and collaboration among parties involved. If disputes cannot be resolved internally, mediation by an outside third party may be pursued.

13. Disclosure Form

All members of IFDC, including board members, committee members, staff, interns, and volunteers, must acknowledge the Code of Ethics by completing a disclosure form upon joining the organization.

By signing below, you acknowledge and agree to abide by the policies outlined in the IFDC Employee Handbook.

Signature: _____

PrintedName: _____

Position: _____

Date: _____